Cheat Sheet: Building Unsupervised Learning Models

Unsupervised learning models

Model Name	Brief Description	Code Syntax
UMAP	UMAP (Uniform Manifold Approximation and Projection) is used for dimensionality reduction. **Pros:** High performance, preserves global structure. **Cons:** Sensitive to parameters. **Applications:** Data visualization, feature extraction. **Key hyperparameters:** • **n_neighbors:** Controls the local neighborhood size (default = 15). • **min_dist:** Controls the minimum distance between points in the embedded space (default = 0.1). • **n_components:** The dimensionality of the embedding (default = 2).	`from umap.umap_ import UMAP` `umap = UMAP(n_neighbors=15, min_dist=0.1, n_components=2)`
t-SNE	t-SNE (t-Distributed Stochastic Neighbor Embedding) is a nonlinear dimensionality reduction technique. **Pros:** Good for visualizing high-dimensional data. **Cons:** Computationally expensive, prone to overfitting. **Applications:** Data visualization, anomaly detection. **Key hyperparameters:** • **n_components:** The number of dimensions for the output (default = 2). • **perplexity:** Balances attention between local and global aspects of the data (default = 30). • **learning_rate:** Controls the step size during optimization (default = 200).	`from sklearn.manifold import TSNE` `tsne = TSNE(n_components=2, perplexity=30, learning_rate=200)`
PCA	PCA (principal component analysis) is used for linear dimensionality reduction. **Pros:** Easy to interpret, reduces noise. **Cons:** Linear, may lose information in nonlinear data. **Applications:** Feature extraction, compression. **Key hyperparameters:** • **n_components:** Number of principal components to retain (default = 2). • **whiten:** Whether to scale the components (default = False). • **svd_solver:** The algorithm to compute the components (default = 'auto').	`from sklearn.decomposition import PCA` `pca = PCA(n_components=2)`
DBSCAN	DBSCAN (Density-Based Spatial Clustering of Applications with Noise) is a density-based clustering algorithm. **Pros:** Identifies outliers, does not require the number of clusters. **Cons:** Difficult with varying density clusters. **Applications:** Anomaly detection, spatial data clustering. **Key hyperparameters:** • **eps:** The maximum distance between two points to be considered neighbors (default = 0.5). • **min_samples:** Minimum number of samples in a neighborhood to form a cluster (default = 5).	`from sklearn.cluster import DBSCAN` `dbscan = DBSCAN(eps=0.5, min_samples=5)`
HDBSCAN	HDBSCAN (Hierarchical DBSCAN) improves on DBSCAN by handling varying density clusters. **Pros:** Better handling of varying densities. **Cons:** Can be slower than DBSCAN.	`import hdbscan` `clusterer = hdbscan.HDBSCAN(min_cluster_size=5)`

Model Name	Brief Description	Code Syntax
	Applications: Large datasets, complex clustering problems. **Key hyperparameters:** • **min_cluster_size:** The minimum size of clusters (default = 5). • **min_samples:** Minimum number of samples to form a cluster (default = 10).	
K-Means clustering	K-Means is a centroid-based clustering algorithm that groups data into k clusters. **Pros:** Efficient, simple to implement. **Cons:** Sensitive to initial cluster centroids. **Applications:** Customer segmentation, pattern recognition. **Key hyperparameters:** • **n_clusters:** Number of clusters (default = 8). • **init:** Method for initializing the centroids ('k-means++' or 'random', default = 'k-means++'). • **n_init:** Number of times the algorithm will run with different centroid seeds (default = 10).	`from sklearn.cluster import KMeans` `kmeans = KMeans(n_clusters=3)`

Associated fuctions used

Method	Brief Description	Code Syntax
make_blobs	Generates isotropic Gaussian blobs for clustering.	`from sklearn.datasets import make_blobs` `X, y = make_blobs(n_samples=100, centers=2, random_state=42)`
multivariate_normal	Generates samples from a multivariate normal distribution.	`from numpy.random import multivariate_normal` `samples = multivariate_normal(mean=[0, 0], cov=[[1, 0], [0, 1]], size=100)`

plotly.express.scatter_3d	Creates a 3D scatter plot using Plotly Express.	`import plotly.express as px`
		`fig = px.scatter_3d(df, x='x', y='y', z='z')`
		`fig.show()`

Method	Brief Description	Code Syntax
geopandas.GeoDataFrame	Creates a GeoDataFrame from a Pandas DataFrame.	`import geopandas as gpd` `gdf = gpd.GeoDataFrame(df, geometry='geometry')`
geopandas.to_crs	Transforms the coordinate reference system of a GeoDataFrame.	`gdf = gdf.to_crs(epsg=3857)`

contextily.add_basemap	Adds a basemap to a GeoDataFrame plot for context.	`import contextily as ctx`
		`ax = gdf.plot(figsize=(10, 10))`
		`ctx.add_basemap(ax)`

pca.explained_variance_ratio_	Returns the proportion of variance explained by each principal component.	`from sklearn.decomposition import PCA`
		`pca = PCA(n_components=2)`
		`pca.fit(X)`
		`variance_ratio = pca.explained_variance_ratio_`

Author

Jeff Grossman
Abhishek Gagneja

Skills Network